

Dynamic Application Security Testing

Using OWASP ZAP



OWASP ZAP is an open source penetration testing tool, which is used to perform dynamic application security testing. Let's learn more about it and find out how to use it.

Dynamic application security testing (DAST) focuses on finding security vulnerabilities in a running application and simulating attacks on it. DAST differs from static application security testing or SAST. The latter focuses on analysing the source code of an application to identify bugs, security vulnerabilities and code smells. The objective of SAST is to identify these issues early in the software development life cycle before they are identified and exploited in the production environment. SAST usually analyses an application's source code, configuration files, infrastructure configuration and build scripts to identify potential bugs and vulnerabilities. We don't need to execute the code to analyse it in SAST.

DAST analyses the behaviour of the deployed application. It finds vulnerabilities and potential risks. DAST tools usually automate the process of simulating attacks such as SQL injection and cross-site scripting (XSS) attacks. DAST is a significant tool for development teams looking to improve the security of applications. We can automate the process of identifying security vulnerabilities in a running application by integrating it in the CI/CD pipeline.

Overview of OWASP ZAP

In software security testing, we assess and verify a system against security risks and vulnerabilities. System security testing can be categorised in the following way: